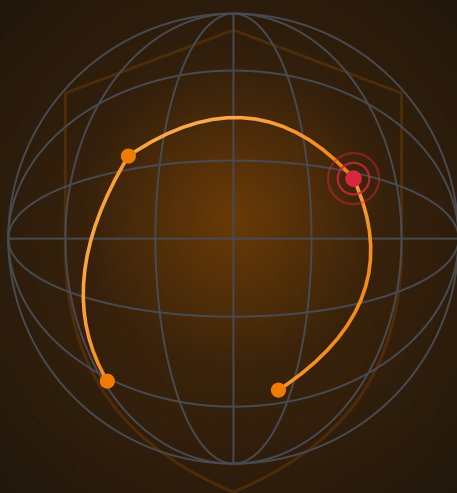




THREAT PULSE

WEEKLY CYBER THREAT BRIEFING

WEEK IN REVIEW · 27 JULY–2 AUGUST 2026

Inside this week: a **critical WordPress flaw** being used to hijack websites worldwide, **critical VMware server bugs** to patch fast, an extortion gang's claimed **breach at a Big Four firm**, and a security-tool zero-day — explained in plain English, with the practical steps that matter.

Welcome to **Threat Pulse**, your plain-English weekly round-up of the cyber threats making waves around the world — and what they mean for your business. This week the spotlight is on **WordPress**, the software behind roughly four in ten of the world's websites, after a critical flaw began letting attackers **take over sites with no password required** — alongside urgent fixes for VMware and a fresh reminder that even trusted suppliers get breached. No jargon, just what happened and the practical steps worth taking.

AT A GLANCE THIS WEEK

 **9.8** /10

Severity of the WordPress flaw now being exploited to take over websites worldwide

 **43** %

Share of the world's websites that run on WordPress, the software under attack

 **Hours**

Time it took for real attacks to begin after the flaw was made public

THIS WEEK'S HEADLINE THREAT

WORDPRESS CORE • CVE-2026-63030 ("WP2SHELL")

A critical WordPress flaw is being used to hijack websites — no password needed



CRITICAL

Exploitation: **active & in the wild**

WHAT'S HAPPENING

A serious weakness in **WordPress Core** (the core software behind a huge share of the world's websites) lets an attacker **take full control of a site without logging in**. Researchers nicknamed it "wp2shell." Working attack code appeared within **hours** of the flaw being made public, and criminals are now scanning the internet for un-updated sites — planting hidden back doors and creating rogue administrator accounts.

WHO'S AFFECTED

Any business running its own **WordPress website** on the affected versions (6.8, 6.9 or 7.0 before the fixes). Because WordPress powers roughly **43% of all websites**, the pool of targets is enormous. The fixes are in WordPress **6.9.5, 7.0.2 and 6.8.6**; fully-managed hosts and WordPress.com sites were largely updated automatically, but self-managed sites need checking.

WHY IT MATTERS TO YOU

A hijacked website can be defaced, used to **steal customer or payment data**, or quietly made to host scams and malware in your name — damaging trust and your search ranking. Because attackers create **hidden admin accounts**, simply updating later may not be enough: a site that was left vulnerable should also be checked for signs of a break-in.

Good news if your site is fully managed or on WordPress.com: WordPress pushed **forced automatic updates**, so many sites were patched for you. If you're unsure, your web team or host can confirm your version in minutes.

What to do about the headline threat

-  Ask your web team or host to confirm your **WordPress is updated** to at least 6.9.5, 7.0.2 or 6.8.6 — the versions that fix this flaw.
-  Because attackers may have got in **before** patching, ask them to **check the site** for unexpected admin accounts, unfamiliar files or plugins, and other signs of tampering.
-  If your site is **fully managed or on WordPress.com**, you're likely already covered — but it's worth a quick confirmation.

OTHER THREATS WORTH KNOWING ABOUT



HIGH

Critical VMware server flaws — patch before attackers do

VMware's **vCenter**, used by many organisations to run their virtual servers, has critical flaws (severity **9.8/10**) that let an attacker slip past the login and run their own code; a related bug can even let one virtual machine break out onto the host. No attacks have been seen yet, but fixes are out and flaws like these are prime targets.

Takeaway: if you or your IT provider run VMware, apply Broadcom's latest updates promptly — these are exactly the bugs criminals rush to exploit.



MEDIUM

Extortion gang claims a breach at a Big Four firm

The **ShinyHunters** group claims it stole client tax documents and personal data linked to **Ernst & Young (EY)** — reportedly by compromising a third-party IT supplier — and threatened to leak it. EY has said it spotted unusual activity earlier in the year and offered affected clients identity monitoring.

Takeaway: your data is only as safe as the suppliers who touch it — ask key vendors how they protect it and how they'd tell you if they were breached.



HIGH

Security tools are targets too: a Check Point zero-day

Attackers exploited a flaw in **Check Point's SmartConsole** management tool to gain **full administrator access without a password**, and a public how-to guide has since been released — raising the risk for anyone still unpatched. Only consoles left **exposed to the internet** are at risk.

Takeaway: never leave an admin or management console open to the whole internet — lock it to known addresses and keep it patched.

★ Your 3-minute checklist this week

- ✓ Update your **WordPress site** to the fixed version (6.9.5, 7.0.2 or 6.8.6) and ask your host to check it for tampering.
- ✓ If you run **VMware**, apply the latest updates from Broadcom.
- ✓ Make sure no admin or management console — websites, firewalls, VMware, security tools — is **exposed to the open internet** without restrictions.
- ✓ Ask your most important **suppliers** how they'd let you know if they were breached.

Threat Pulse is provided by DPG-Cyber for general awareness only and does not constitute specific security or legal advice. Threat details are drawn from reputable public reporting as at 3 August 2026 and may evolve as investigations continue. For guidance tailored to your environment, please contact your DPG-Cyber account team.

BEHIND THE HEADLINES

Why a **watchful eye** changes the outcome

Every threat in this issue had one thing in common: the damage happened in the **quiet gap between the break-in and the moment someone noticed**. Tools alone rarely stop an attack — what limits the harm is continuous monitoring that correlates the signals, spots the intrusion early, and responds before a foothold becomes a crisis.

241 days

Average time for organisations to identify *and* contain a breach

SOURCE: IBM COST OF A DATA BREACH 2025

\$4.44M

Global average total cost of a single data breach

SOURCE: IBM COST OF A DATA BREACH 2025

THE WINDOW THAT MATTERS

Intrusion
the way in

Foothold
quietly settling in

Lateral movement
spreading across systems

Impact
data theft / ransomware

↑ The sooner an attack is spotted, the smaller the damage. Closing this window — detecting and responding on the left, long before impact on the right — is the entire job of a Security Operations Centre.

WHAT CONTINUOUS MONITORING QUIETLY DOES



Sees across everything

A SIEM gathers and correlates activity from across your systems, so unusual behaviour stands out instead of hiding in the noise.



Watches around the clock

Attacks don't keep office hours. A SOC means real people monitoring day, night and weekends — not just 9 to 5.



Knows the latest tactics

Fresh threat intelligence — like the WordPress and VMware flaws in this issue — feeds detection so new tricks are recognised fast.



Acts, not just alerts

Alerts are triaged and investigated by analysts who step in early, turning a would-be incident into a non-event.

This is the quiet, everyday work behind **DPG-Cyber's SIEM & SOC services** — the same monitoring and response that turns headlines like these into non-events for the businesses we look after. If you're ever curious how it would map to your own environment, we're always happy to talk it through, no pressure — just drop us a line at hello@dpg-cyber.com.